

across enterprises, is that the data sets are fragmented and there is a patchwork infrastructure that exists.

Enterprises need someone who can modernise the infrastructure and also implement AI as one integrated approach. That's where the whole digital native velocity getting married to enterprise-grade delivery maturity comes in. And that's the space we think is ripe for disruption.

SHELLEY: Platforms like Anthropic Claude Cowork can help non-coders write code. AI is already writing around 30% of the code. How does that change the IT services narrative?

A: If you were to walk across the operating floor of tech services firms like Coforge and start counting the number of people who are writing bespoke code, which is what AI does exceptionally well, you will find that it is not a very big number. We are in the business of creating business solutions, integrating platforms. We are not, for the most part, into writing bespoke code.

So, I can't for a second disagree with you around the fact that AI is an exceptional tool when it comes to writing code and the Anthropic example is very relevant.

But my submission is—that's not all that we do. And second, there are just so many new service offerings that can get created by way of business solutions, by technology services providers that have the capability and, more importantly, the resolve to pivot.

SHELLEY: AI will shrink the 'run the business' budgets, the maintenance kind of tasks, the legacy tasks so to say, which fuel IT firms. How do you ensure that gains from new AI projects outpace the revenue lost to automated efficiencies?

A: By focusing equally on the innovation budget. You're absolutely right, if the 'run the business' stays the same where it is right now, it will shrink. The innovation piece will always keep expanding. It's the classical conversation that keeps happening around testing. Even if you go back 10 years, people have been saying that testing services revenues will fall. They aren't falling, they're growing pretty robustly.

So, the estate is expanding on the run side, and yes, efficiency will keep contracting it. But innovation is a massive spend bucket.

SHELLEY: We are also seeing geopolitical headwinds, visa issues, tariffs, etc. How are they impacting client spendings and the IT work they outsource to third-party providers?

A: I think there is a natural tendency to watch out for the risks associated with outsourcing and there is therefore the concomitant ask that is coming up for near-shore capabilities, and in many cases for onshore capabilities.

SHELLEY: How do you see the rise of Global Capability Centres or GCCs?

A: I would not necessarily see it as competition. There is obviously an element of competition, there is also the aspect around co-opting them and potentially looking at ways in which we can work with them.

SHELLEY: What would you say is the biggest challenge for the IT industry? Is it the GCCs? Is it the AI led disruption? Or is it the tariff-led policy uncertainty?

A: I would flip each of these and look at the opportu-

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nity as well. But if it's only the challenge, then the lens that we're looking at could possibly be geopolitical.

AI is an incredible opportunity for tech service providers. There are newer markets around the innovation budget, around the services layer, around the industry specialisation that opened up.

SHELLEY: Given the geopolitical and visa issues, are clients holding back spending? Is it impacting discretionary spending?

A: Discretionary technology budgets in calendar year 2026 seem to be more or less in line. They don't seem to have contracted over calendar year 2025. If the question is, have they gone up materially, the answer is, no. But they also haven't contracted. They have gone up possibly marginally. So things aren't all doom and gloom. **BT**

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